



Cambridge IGCSE™

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/22

Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

February/March 2020

INSERT

2 hours

INFORMATION

- This insert contains the reading texts.
- You may annotate this insert and use the blank spaces for planning. **Do not write your answers** on the insert.



This document has 4 pages. Blank pages are indicated.

Read **both** texts, and then answer **Question 1** on the question paper.

Text A: Why you may have good reason to worry about smart devices

This online article discusses some concerns about new technology.

Thanks to new technology an estimated 1.5 trillion objects globally could one day connect to the Internet, everything from simple household objects to unmanned taxi-drones. In the so-called Internet of Things (IoT), each object will be capable of sending and receiving data just as laptops, smartphones and tablets can today. But if Internet-connected wearables or smart home devices didn't make your shopping list this year, it may be because of growing concerns about how careless the makers seem to be with the data their devices collect. 5

So far, the smart people who want us to buy their smart things have been pretty stupid. In their rush to get intelligent fitness trackers, mattresses and fairy-lights to market, developers just aren't paying enough attention to privacy and security issues. Because of this oversight, people have been slower to buy and use connected devices than expected and 47 per cent state privacy and security concerns are a reason. 10

That's bad news for everyone. The IoT will transform our cars, homes, and offices by adding digital intelligence, creating smart devices. Smart devices will benefit consumers, taking over boring activities such as paying bills or reordering cleaning supplies. One online service already enables 'smart' pet-feeders to reorder pet-food on their own. Critics worry that this might have disruptive implications for how, or even whether, consumers will search for products, compare prices and evaluate reviews. According to its promoters, the IoT will customise our experiences, simplify our lives and improve the efficiency of modern urban life. 15

With all that potential value to society, unsurprisingly, the IoT has attracted investors and entrepreneurs worldwide. Already, the IoT market is generating billions in revenue, bringing with it promises of new jobs. 20

Given the security weaknesses in some of today's devices, there is cause for concern. So far, our smart things don't exhibit very good judgement. What if our possessions were told by advertisers to buy certain products or avoid others? What happens when your house, under pressure to be environmentally friendly, decides it knows better than you do when to turn off the lights? 25

Text B: Why are some people quicker than others to use new technology?

The speaker is addressing a group of business people who sell technology products and services.

For a while now, I've studied why customers buy new technology.

Customers fall into three groups.

Group one, people I call 'early adopters', consists of individuals who drive their social status by knowing the latest-and-greatest in what's happening in the tech space. They enjoy the thrill of having something before others, knowing details about what's happening, and being part of the 'insider' community of the tech world. They don't need the products for what they do, they just want to be at the leading edge of use. You can think of them like amateur movie reviewers who go to practically every movie, to serve as an informed authority for others on how good it is and what needs improving. Once another product comes out to replace it, these people will use the original infrequently.

5

10

There's another group who want to be first because they need to keep up for professional reasons. They are usually in the tech community. They'll buy a new product to understand the core of the innovations that are happening. Their interest isn't in using the product. But they want to see what makes the product tick and how to exploit any good ideas for other projects they have. They don't really care about the product itself, or the company that made it.

15

The final group, the 'normals', buys a new product or service if it promises to meet a need they find very pressing or solve a problem they have. Sometimes it's hard to persuade this group they even have a problem. Normals will wait until someone close to them shares their experience of a particular product or service. Once normals can see the need and the benefits, they'll be more likely to try the new product or service.

20

People have routines and rituals in their life that make change difficult and change is costly. There are the financial implications of purchasing something new versus keeping the old thing. Free trials and other 'try me' promotions can help to persuade them, but there's also the hassle of moving data and procedures to the new thing. People know how to use their existing product and trust it. With the new one, they have to take time to learn everything all over again.

25

Frustratingly, some people, once they have a working solution, will refuse to change until that product completely dies. These people resist any new product until they have no other option.

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0500/22

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2 hours

You will need: Insert (enclosed)

- Answer **two** questions in total:
Section A: answer Question 1.
Section B: answer **one** question.
- Use a black or dark blue pen.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen or correction fluid.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- If additional space is needed, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet; the question number or numbers must be clearly shown.
- Dictionaries are **not** allowed.

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [].
- The insert contains the reading texts.

This document has **12** pages. Blank pages are indicated.

Read Text A and Text B in the insert and then answer **Section A, Question 1** on this question paper.

Section A: Directed Writing

Question 1

Write a magazine article for young people about how far they should keep up with the latest technologies.

In your article you should:

- evaluate the views and attitudes people have towards new technology
- give your own views, based on what you have read.

Base your article on what you have read in **both** texts, but be careful to use your own words. Address both of the bullet points.

Begin your article with a suitable headline.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.

This image shows a full page of a handwriting practice worksheet. It features multiple sets of horizontal dashed lines spaced evenly down the page, providing a guide for letter height and placement. The background is plain white, and there are no other markings or text present.

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[Turn to page 6 for Section B]

Section B: Composition

Answer **one** question from Section B.

Write about 350 to 450 words on **one** of the following questions. Answer on this question paper.

Up to 16 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer, and up to 24 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.

EITHER

Descriptive Writing

2 Write a description of a place you would like to go back to.

OR

Descriptive Writing

3 Describe the other contestants in a competition before, and after, the winner has won.

OR

Narrative Writing

4 Write a story which involves some sort of delay.

OR

Narrative Writing

5 Write a story set in two different times or places.

Please write your chosen question number here (2, 3, 4, 5):

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